



THE MCCOMBS SCHOOL AT UT AUSTIN

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT MCCOMBS SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

Known as the “Harvard of Texas,” Texas McCombs is a world-class public university with a 40-acre campus nestled in the 11th largest city in the United States. With strengths in technology and entrepreneurship, the McCombs School of Business leverages its Austin location, a city increasingly known for being a technology centre with increasing number of ex-Silicon Valley transplants. Austin is also routinely ranked among the best cities in the US for business, education, and the arts.

The full-time MBA class is made up of less than 250 students, making it one of the smaller top-20 MBA programs. Of the 22 concentrations offered, 14 are STEM certified. Entrepreneurship, Management Consulting, Clean Tech, Innovation Leadership, and Supply Chain & Operations Management rank in the top five chosen by MBA students.

Students can choose from a dozen degree options offered at UT Austin, including Communications, Global Policy, and Public Affairs, among others. The school boasts nearly 50 student-led organizations, spanning a range of professional, social, and affinity groups.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Accounting, Technology, Entrepreneurship

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
BusinessWeek	20	23	21	21	*
Financial Times	46	44	37	40	40
Forbes	17	-	18	-	-
The Economist	35	25	26	-	*
US News	17	17	19	18	18

CLASS OF 2022 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	1964	Avg Age	29
MBA Class Size	242	Avg GMAT	704
Admissions selectivity	37%	Avg GPA	3.43
Yield	33.3%	% International	10%
Total Tuition	US\$113,144	% Women	34%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

Technology	31.8%
Consulting	22%
Financial Services	17.8%
Consumer Products	7.9%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Amazon, PwC, Deloitte, Dell Technologies, BCG

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: \$128,586

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 88%

*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR UT AUSTIN APPLICATION

BY SHARON JOYCE

With over 25 years of experience in admissions and student affairs, Sharon is a seasoned professional in higher education who has been lauded for her innovative approaches in streamlining interview processes at multiple institutions and her efforts to create inclusive communities in graduate education.



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McCombs students can
leverage a network of
500,000+ UT Austin alumni.**

1

ENTREPRENEURSHIP IS A STRENGTH

With a mantra of “Human Centered. Future Focused,” McCombs is a great place for those targeting entrepreneurship. The Herb Kelleher Center for Entrepreneurship promotes cross-campus collaboration on research and experiential learning activities supporting startup creation. Through the Texas Venture Lab accelerator, companies have raised \$491 million in funding for 178 startups – McCombs students greatly benefit from the thought leadership that comes to campus to engage with students involved with the lab. Finally, the new Social Innovation Initiative inspires and educates students to create economic value while also creating positive social and environmental impact.

MCCOMBS TAKES PRIDE IN BEING PART OF A LARGER A PUBLIC INSTITUTION

2

It’s important to demonstrate enthusiasm and excitement that McCombs is part of the University of Texas, Austin. Considered a “public Ivy,” McCombs students can leverage a network of 500,000+ University of Texas at Austin alumni (the list of alumni includes notable graduates ranging from Michael Dell, Laura Bush, and Matthew McConaughey) and 100,000+ McCombs alumni who are eager to network with their fellow “Longhorns*.”

3

COMMITTED TO A DIVERSITY OF PERSPECTIVES

A hallmark of the MBA program at McCombs is a commitment to a diversity of perspectives. Noting this: "Collaboration drives everything we do," McCombs champions diversity in the classroom and strives to develop student leaders whose mindsets will transcend geographic and cultural boundaries. The number of clubs for specific affinity groups is impressive - be sure to think about one or two you would plan to join if accepted; McCombs students are highly active participants in the 45+ MBA-specific organizations.

ROWLING HALL IS EXCEPTIONAL

4

Only two years old, the 497,500-square-foot graduate business facility, Robert B. Rowling Hall, is the envy of most b-school programs. From the school's website: "Rowling Hall is designed to convene and inspire bright minds and enterprising leaders from around the university and beyond. Every corner of the building, from the expansive entry hall to the Moontower Café, has been created to promote conversation, camaraderie and idea-sharing among students, faculty members, staff members, alumni, recruiters, executives, and other business school visitors and guests." Students joke that they never want to leave school because the new building offers everything they need, including ample study spaces, beautiful outdoor terraces, an MBA gym/locker room, and a comfy student lounge.

5

KEEP AUSTIN WEIRD

"Keep Austin Weird" was a slogan initially adopted to promote small businesses in Austin, but the larger implication is that Austin, and the University of Texas, attracts vanguard cultural events, such as Austin City Limits Music Festival and South by Southwest. McCombs students have pride in living in the "Live Music Capital of the World" and attend numerous on and off-campus performances (some at a discount). There is also a vibrant "foodie" scene in Austin that the students rave about; those in the MBA Brewing Association and Graduate Business Wine Club enjoy connecting with local businesses to support them and to learn more about the food/beverage industry.

HOOK 'EM HORNS

6

A University of Texas cheerleader introduced the "Hook 'em Horns" hand sign at a pep rally in 1955 and it is now an internationally recognized greeting for Longhorns*. It's even used in written correspondence as: Type a forward slash "/" . When put together, the "\m/" emoticon resembles the "hook 'em horns" hand gesture. Don't be surprised if your emails from those at McCombs have the Hook 'em wording, usually as the closing line in a message to you.

*A Longhorn is a type of steer (cattle) and is the UT Austin mascot, lovingly named "Bevo".

For more insider tips into McCombs visit the Fortuna [blog](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	FINAL DECISION
Round 1	12 Oct 2021	16 Dec 2021
Round 2	06 Jan 2022	24 March 2022
Round 3	29 March 2022	5 May 2022

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**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, MIT Sloan, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

